

LocalAds Manager

Design Documentation — Google Ads API Developer Token Application

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1. Overview

LocalAds Manager is an **internal campaign-management tool** used by our agency to plan, create, monitor, and optimize Google Ads Search campaigns for the local-business clients whose advertising we manage. The tool is operated exclusively by our own staff under our Manager (MCC) account. It is **not** licensed, sold, or made available to any third party, and no third party interacts with the Google Ads API through it.

The tool exists to apply a consistent, conservative optimization methodology for local service businesses (tight match types, precise geographic targeting, structured negative keyword management) and to give our account managers a review-and-approve workflow so that every material change to a client account is deliberate, logged, and auditable.

2. Users and Access Model

- **Users:** internal agency staff only (account managers). Each user authenticates to the tool itself; the tool authenticates to the Google Ads API via OAuth 2.0 credentials tied to our Manager account.
- **Accounts accessed:** only client accounts linked under our MCC, with standard Google Ads account-linking consent.
- **No third-party access:** the tool is internal-use software. It is not offered as a SaaS product and has no external sign-up.

3. System Architecture

The system has four components:

- **Web dashboard** — internal web application where staff view account performance, review and approve proposed changes, create campaigns, and export reports/audits.
- **Strategy engine** — a deterministic rules layer that evaluates account performance against our local-business playbook and produces *change proposals* with written reasoning (e.g., add a negative keyword, adjust a keyword bid, pause an underperforming ad).
- **Scheduler / sync service** — fetches reporting data on a fixed schedule (1–2 times per day per account) and caches it locally so the dashboard does not generate per-pageview API traffic.
- **Google Ads API integration layer** — a single gateway module through which all API calls pass. It enforces guardrails (Section 6), batching, retry/backoff, and full audit logging of every mutate operation.

Change proposals flow through a human review queue by default (“review mode”). An account may be switched to “automatic mode,” in which pre-approved, low-risk change types are applied without per-change sign-off; all changes remain logged and visible in the dashboard either way.

4. Google Ads API Services Used

API Service	Operations	Purpose
GoogleAdsService (SearchStream)	Read	Scheduled retrieval of campaign, ad group, keyword, search-term, and geographic performance reports.
CampaignService	Read / Mutate	Create Search campaigns; update campaign settings (network settings, status). Budget fields are never mutated — see Section 6.
CampaignBudgetService	Create only	Create a budget once at campaign creation, at the amount entered by the account manager. The tool contains no code path that updates an existing budget.
AdGroupService	Read / Mutate	Create and organize ad groups; pause/enable.
AdGroupAdService	Read / Mutate	Create responsive search ads; pause underperforming ads after human review.
AdGroupCriterionService	Read / Mutate	Add/edit keywords (phrase and exact match), set keyword-level bids, add ad-group negatives.
CampaignCriterionService	Read / Mutate	Location targeting (radius/geo, “presence” setting), campaign negative keywords, ad schedules.
SharedSetService / SharedCriterionService	Read / Mutate	Maintain shared negative keyword lists per client vertical.
AssetService / CampaignAssetService	Read / Mutate	Call, sitelink, callout, and location assets.
RecommendationService	Read / Dismiss	Recommendations are surfaced to staff for information only; the tool never auto-applies recommendations.

5. API Usage Patterns and Volume

- Reporting syncs run on a schedule (typically twice daily per client account) using GoogleAdsService.SearchStream, with results cached in our database. Dashboard page views are served from the cache, not live API calls.
- Mutate operations are batched per service and submitted only when a human approves a proposal (review mode) or when a pre-approved rule fires (automatic mode). Expected volume is low — tens of mutate operations per account per week.
- The integration layer implements exponential backoff with jitter on RESOURCE_EXHAUSTED / transient errors and respects all documented rate limits and daily operation quotas.
- Initial usage: fewer than 50 client accounts under one MCC. Basic Access quota is sufficient.

6. Guardrails and Change Safety

- **Budget immutability:** the integration layer hard-blocks any mutate touching CampaignBudget amounts after creation. Budget changes are made only by a human directly in the Google Ads interface.
- **Cooldown windows:** the strategy engine will not modify the same entity more than once within a configured cooldown period, and bid adjustments are capped per change, preventing oscillating or aggressive automation.

- **Statistical thresholds:** keywords/ads are only proposed for pausing after sufficient data volume, never on small samples.
- **Full audit trail:** every API mutate is recorded with timestamp, operator (or rule), before/after values, and reasoning; auditable and exportable from the dashboard.

7. Data Storage, Privacy, and Security

- The tool stores campaign structure and aggregate performance metrics (impressions, clicks, conversions, cost) per client account. It does not collect or store end-user data or personally identifiable information.
- OAuth 2.0 refresh tokens and the developer token are stored encrypted in environment-level secrets, never in source control or client-side code.
- Performance data for one client account is never shared with, or used to make decisions for, any other client account.
- Access to the dashboard is restricted to authenticated agency staff over HTTPS.

8. Compliance

- The tool is internal-use software operated by the advertiser's authorized agency; it is not distributed to third parties, so third-party Required Minimum Functionality obligations do not apply. It nonetheless supports full campaign creation, management, and reporting workflows.
- The tool complies with the Google Ads API Terms and Conditions and the Google Ads API policies, including data-use and attribution requirements.
- No scraping, no automated account creation, no circumvention of Google Ads policies. All advertising content is created or approved by account managers.

9. Dashboard Screens (Summary)

- **Accounts overview** — all linked client accounts with mode (review/automatic), spend pace, and key metrics.
- **Account detail** — campaigns, ad groups, keywords, and search terms with cached performance data.
- **Proposal queue** — pending changes with reasoning; approve, edit, or reject. Approval triggers the corresponding batched mutate.
- **Campaign builder** — guided Search-campaign creation enforcing our local-business standards (match types, geo settings, negatives, assets).
- **Reports & audits** — exportable performance reports and account audits (CSV/PDF) for client communication.